From Product Tours to AI That Sets Up the Account With You

upvance

Area: Technology TREND

B2B products replace tours and onboarding calls with an assistant that reads the customer's own data, drafts the setup and walks a new user to a first useful result. It is early: only 25% of 150 surveyed customer-success leaders have AI built into onboarding end-to-end (OnRamp, 2026).

FORCES

- Embedded assistants become standard in business apps
- Slow time-to-value makes customers leave
- Human-led onboarding doesn't scale
- Assistants draft setup from existing customer data
- Users skip tutorials and product tours

VALUES

- A first result over a completed training
- Work done for you over explanations
- Approval before change over silent automation
- Self-service for simple cases over calls
- Proven impact over perceived impact

PHASE

Emerging

Only 25% of 150 surveyed leaders have AI end-to-end in onboarding (2026, vendor survey); every outcome figure so far is company-reported.

EXAMPLES

- HoneyBook (US, 2025): its onboarding agent lifted trial-to-subscription 36% against a control group.
- BILL (Oct 2026): AI drafts the account setup; users cut setup time by up to 50%.
- Starshipit (NZ/AU, Sep 2026): 23% of new users used the AI setup agent unprompted in five weeks.
- WeMind (2026): AI voice onboarding reached 68% week-one activation vs 45% in a randomized test.
- OnRamp survey (2025, 161 CS leaders): 48% say customers abandon onboarding when value comes slowly.

INNOVATORS

- Xero, an early onboarding assistant
- Salesforce's Setup agent asks before changing
- Zendesk made AI setup part of the trial
- Jochem van der Veer, TheyDo CEO
- Gartner frames embedded assistants as default

IMPACT

- ▲ A new admin states a goal, the assistant drafts the setup, the user confirms, and the first session ends with a result.
- ▼ The assistant sets things up wrongly or the user confirms blindly, so the account exists but nobody uses it.
- Speed or control: an agent that asks before every change is safer but slows the first result.
- Only 30% of teams use AI to spot stalled onboarding, so most discover non-use after month one.

RO/EU lens: Romania has the EU's lowest business AI use (5.2% vs 20.0% of companies, 2025); no RO or EU data on in-product AI onboarding was found.

Why it matters: The question shifts from 'did they finish the tour?' to 'did they get one useful result?'

Sources: 18 sources, short research, in the Research document